



July 2006

Pornography Woes

The *Fast Track to Web Design* was marvellous. I can now develop PHP pages very easily. The July issue was amazing—it was more informative and had fewer ads. And the article on online pornography was great. I now understand that we never control pornography. I think sex education should be started in the 11th grade, so that our teenagers can understand what they should and shouldn't do. This is the best work by *Digit* on online pornography.

Anand S Newasekar

I wrote this letter because of the July story, "Do you know what children are exposed to online." I'm very happy that you have written about this topic as it is a matter of concern for everyone. I think the Net really is the sleaziest place in the world right now, while being accessible to almost everyone. I am a student and have dial-up at home, though my future children will probably enjoy a 24x7 broadband connection. I don't think installing content-blocking software is the solution, because none of them provide complete protection. So, while pondering over this issue I have come up with a solution that may be practical:

Let's have a toolbar that only an administrator account on a computer can install, which children or other users will not be able to uninstall or disable. In an online community effort, everyone should have this toolbar. After registering on the toolbar's site using an e-mail address and password, they can then mark all sites that they come across as clean or objectionable. This way a central database can be maintained and added to.

If this is done, in a couple of years we may be able to find all the sites with adult content and block them!

I think breakthru.com is doing a good job to combat spam.

Mubashir Zahoor Bhat
Anantnag, Kashmir

Dear Anand and Mubashir,
We're glad that you and a lot of other people understood the stand that *Digit* decided to take in trying to pry open the eyes of the public, and force them to see that such things will not just go away on their own—not talking about it is only making it worse.

As far as sex education is concerned, it needs to start at home, and not done as dispassionately as it is in schools and colleges. Also, with the younger generation being more technologically inclined than the older one, trying to stop kids from viewing porn online is almost always going to fail.

Mubashir, your idea, though unique, is not the solution, because adult sites are multiplying by the minute, and blocking all of them is next to impossible. The solution is to accept the fact that if our children *want* to view pornography online, they *will*! What we have to make sure of is that they aren't scarred emotionally by it, because porn is their only source of information on the subject of sex. Take away the taboo that is associated with the subject, and all of a sudden it's not an adrenaline rush anymore! That's the approach most of us at *Digit* wish to take... We thank you for standing up and being counted, and raising your voices on this subject—unlike most of the people we approached for this article, who heard the words "sex," "pornography" or "adult Web site" and closed the door on our face!

— Agent001

Bouquets For The Fast Track...

Your *Fast Track to Web Design* was a mind-blowing presentation, and I have rejoiced at its presence with this month's *Digit*. I do not have words to thank you for this remarkable addition to the *Fast Track* series, which I think is a super hit element in your magazine. Keep up the good work.

Nirmalendu Mukherjee
West Bengal

I have been reading your magazine for more than four years now. Your new technology guide, "Fast Track", has been very useful for me from the time it was launched with the March 2005 issue. It has been a really handy and useful companion thus far. I have to say that

the choice of the topic in each fast track has been improving with every issue.

The debut issue covered Digital Photography—a gem of a topic, considering that very few IT magazines have ever covered this topic. I am thankful for your Mobile Telephony issue as well, because I took that as my seminar topic for my final semester in MSc Physics, and all my professors loved it. Your April issue's *Fast Track* was all about Linux—and since my MSc project was on Linux Scripting, that helped me a lot as well. You've done it again with Web Design—I was looking forward to learning the basics of PHP, and *Digit* has helped me yet again!

Thanks a lot for the master brains behind such a great idea, and do continue to update us in IT. It seems that *Digit* is my "mind reader".

Kelvin Ralph

Dear Nirmalendu and Kelvin,
I am glad that you liked our *Fast Track* books. Thanks for your feedback, and we promise to keep it just as interesting, if not more.

— Executive Editor

...And Brickbats For The Couriers

I was really surprised to see that my first letter to you was published, and instead of the article on Digital Audio, you gave an entire *Fast Track* on the topic! Kudos to you for that!

I have been very happy by the prompt responses from your helpdesk, on several occasions, but I cannot say the same for your subscription service, which is your Achilles Heel! Most ardent readers like me end up as subscribers for mainly two reasons. First, it's the ease of having *Digit* delivered to you, and second, in the vain hope of getting the magazine on a priority basis. You must realise that we subscribers receive our copies much later than newsstand buyers do. I saw this month's (July) edition on the stands on July 1 itself, but my issue normally gets to me by the 10th of the month. You guys must make it a point to give your subscribers, your most important customers, the issues before they get to the news stand.

Please take up this matter seriously, and satisfy your most loyal customers!

Praveen Premchandran

Dear Praveen,
I know that subscriber copies sometimes reach